ER OUT-OF-NETWORK REVENUE CYCLE

Operating Model for 2027

Moving IDR Gateway work onshore by January 1, replacing facility teams with full-cycle teams, and getting ready to grow from 12 to 31 facilities

[Presenter name] · Revenue Cycle Leadership · October 2026

SUMMARY

Three changes, and one date we can't move

1 · By January 1

Move Gateway data entry to a small US desk

Model C: a US team of 1 lead and 4 associates copies what our Lebanon team prepares in the IDR Prep Studio. The decisions stay with us.

2 · January to February 2027

Replace facility teams with 10 full-cycle teams

Each manager runs one team that owns a balanced book of payers, from coding to final payment. Workload evens out, and new facilities don't need new teams.

3 · Through 2027

Promote on skill, not job title

One RCM Specialist role: a junior level, 4 specialist levels and a leadership level, earned through 15 skill badges.

No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same standards.

WHY NOW

Three things are pushing us at the same time

Jan 1

The IDR Gateway goes US-only

Only US-based staff will be able to work in the Gateway. Our negotiators spend 50–70% of their time there today, on 2,500 batched disputes a month.

5×

Workload is uneven

Our busiest facility team carries 704 open claims per person. The lightest carries 138. Same job, same pay.

12 → 31

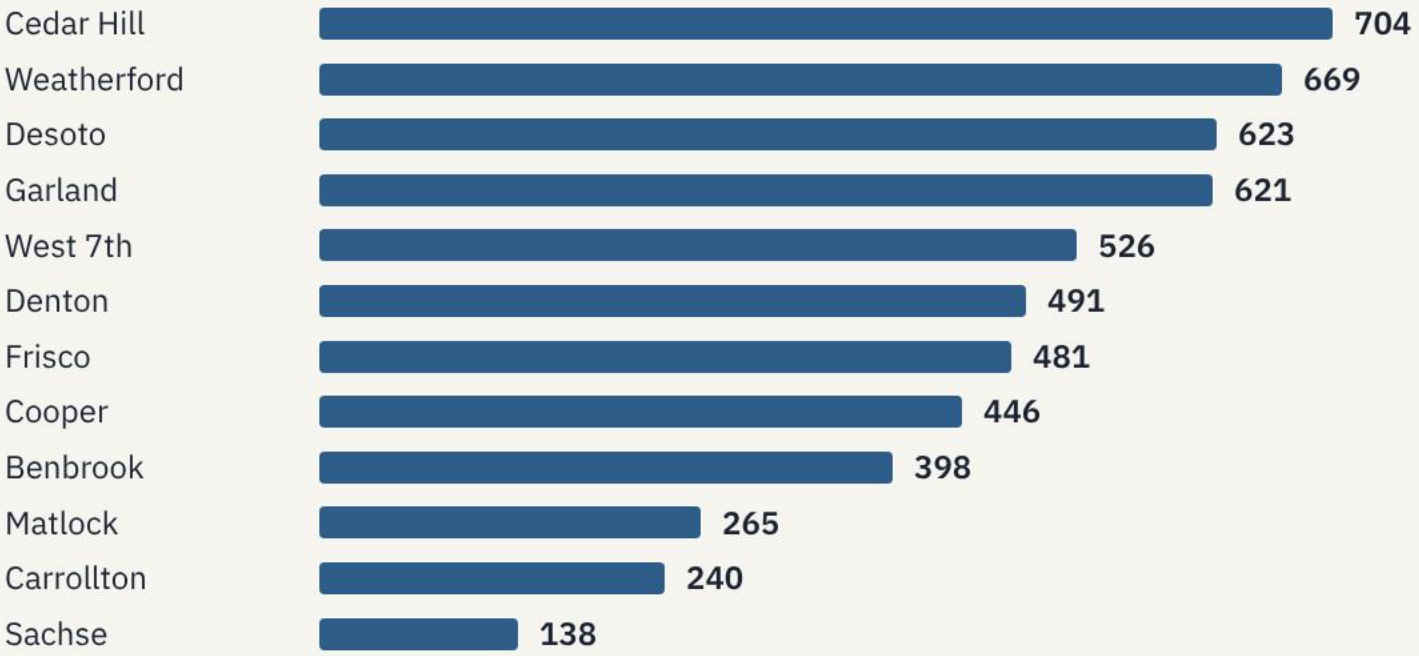
We're about to grow fast

9 facilities open next year and 10 the year after. Under today's setup, each one needs its own new team.

TODAY

Same job, up to five times the workload

Open claims per team member, by facility team



493

Average open claims per person across all 12 teams.

Because people are tied to one facility, we can't move work from Cedar Hill to Sachse without reorganizing.

Source: 41,375 open claims, Oct 2026; 84 team members excluding managers · 4

TODAY

Where the current setup costs us

Area	What happens today	What it costs us
Facility teams	Each team works one location only	Load varies 5× between teams; every new site needs a new team
Handoffs	Billers send the Open Negotiation notice, then negotiators take over	Two owners on our most deadline-sensitive step
Coding	10 coders handle about 120 charts a day, roughly 12 each	About half of our coding capacity sits idle
Medical-necessity reports	About 70 people each write them for their own visits	The same task done 70 different ways
NNSA appeals	Claims are appealed for 4–5 years after the date of service	Our analysis found no recoveries after year one
Seniority titles	Titles exist but don't decide who works on what	Strong coders and billers have no path past negotiators

THE TARGET MODEL

Ten teams do the work; a small US desk files it

LEBANON · 94 PEOPLE

Team 1	Team 2	Team 3	Team 4	Team 5
Team 6	Team 7	Team 8	Team 9	Team 10

One manager per team. Each team has 1 team lead and 7–8 RCM specialists, and owns a balanced book of payers from coding to closure.

Also in Lebanon

An opt-in night rota covers the US day. Our separate QA department audits quality and sits on the Badge Panel.



Disputes prepared in the IDR Prep Studio



Results and determinations

UNITED STATES · 5 PEOPLE

US Gateway Desk

1 working lead and 4 associates on two shifts. They copy each prepared dispute into the Gateway, submit it, and download determinations.

They follow the Studio. They don't make pricing or strategy calls.

FULL-CYCLE TEAMS

One owner per account, start to finish

1
Code the chart
Plus the medical-necessity report, done once

2
Confirm receipt
Log the mail date, confirm the payer has it

3
Open negotiation
OMB notice, then 30 business days to settle

4
IDR or appeal
Prepared in the IDR Prep Studio, filed by the US desk

5
Post and match
Payments posted, awards matched to rulings

6
Close
Unpaid awards chased after 30 days

Who's in a team

1 manager, 1 team lead and 7–8 specialists handling about 12 visits a day. Each team gets a similar mix of payers, dollar values and seniority, so teams can be compared fairly.

How work gets routed

If the owner holds the skill badge for a step, they do it. If not, a badge-holder in the same team does it while the owner learns. Work never leaves the team.

THREE WAYS TO FILE

We propose Model C, the guided copy desk

	A · People-first	B · Automation-first	C · Guided copy desk (proposed)
How filing works	US desk types from ClickUp tickets	A form filler fills the Gateway; operator checks	**US desk copies each field from the IDR Prep Studio**
Time per dispute	About 47 min	Target 10 min	**Target 15 min**
US desk, today → year 2	7 → 18	3 → 7	**5 → 11**
Cost a year, today	$346–421K	$192–244K	**$252–307K**
Cost a year, year 2	$861K–1.05M	$412–504K	**$533–650K**
Outside approvals	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule	Same, plus written Gateway approval of assisted filling	**Onshore rule sign-off only**
Ready for Jan 1	Yes	No; runs on A's desk until April 30	**Yes; the Studio is built and tested**
Main risk	Cost grows with volume	Gateway terms; a 3-person desk	**Copy errors, caught by Studio checks and a per-field checklist**

US desk cost at Texas rates plus 25% benefits. C saves $94–114K today and $328–400K in year 2 vs A · 8

US GATEWAY DESK · MODEL C

How we stay in the Gateway after January 1

1. The team prepares each dispute in the IDR Prep Studio, which mirrors the Gateway page by page and checks every field.
2. A ClickUp ticket reaches the US desk by 3:30 pm Beirut time, 7:30 am in Dallas.
3. A US associate copies each field with one-click buttons and submits personally. No tool touches the Gateway.
4. The night rota fixes rejects the same US day; results wait for the Beirut morning.

SIZING

1 lead + 4

Two staggered shifts, 07:00–19:00 Central. 2,500 disputes a month at 15 minutes each.

$252–307K a year today. 8 people in year 1, 11 in year 2.

Hired in-house from October, plus 2 on 3–6 month contracts until Gate C1.

Gate C1, March 15: 15 minutes or less, errors under 0.5%, no missed deadlines for 4 weeks. Then contracts end and the desk runs at 5.

BRIDGE NIGHT ROTA

An opt-in night rota, paid from a fixed pool

Item	What we expect
Who	Any L2, L3 or L4 holding B2 opts in. An A2 holder leads each night.
Hours	16:00–24:00 Beirut, Monday to Friday (08:00–16:00 Central)
Staffing	2 a night: 10 member-nights a week, 130 a quarter
Duties	Check tickets due today; answer the US desk in 15 min; fix rejects the same US day; post the handover log
Targets	98% first pass; no deadline missed because of a ticket

$30,000 a quarter, shared equally

Rota size	Each, a quarter
10 members	$3,000
15 members	$2,000
20 members	$1,500
30 members	$1,000
50 members	$600
100 members (cap)	$300

About $230 per night worked, at any rota size; up to $120,000 a year. Full share when targets are met and all assigned nights are worked. Transport home after the shift.

PORTFOLIOS

Work is assigned by payer, weighted by effort

Three portfolio tiers

Tier	Owned by	What's in it
Tier 1	L3 and L4 Senior Specialists	Highest-dollar claims, hardest payers, complex batches
Tier 2	L2 Specialist II	Standard NSA claims
Tier 3	L1 Specialist I	Lower-dollar, high-volume, batch-heavy claims

Work units per task

Task	Units
Open Negotiation notice	1
Negotiation	2
NNSA appeal	2
IDR initiation	3
Offer and packet	4
MVA settlement	5

Net Recovery = (collected − initial payment − IDR fees not refunded) ÷ (billed − initial payment)

Compared only within the same tier. Unit weights are starting values until our two-week time study.

CAREERS

One role, six levels, 15 skill badges

Level	Badges required	How you get it
L0 Junior RCM Specialist	None: newly recruited	On hire
L1 RCM Specialist I	All 5 C	**Automatic** once the badges are held
L2 RCM Specialist II	All 5 C + B1 or B2 + 2 of B3, B4, B5	**Automatic** once the badges are held
L3 Senior Specialist I	All 5 C + all 5 B + 1 of 5 A	Badges, then the **L3 leveling test**
L4 Senior Specialist II	All 5 C + all 5 B + 3 of 5 A	Badges, then the **L4 leveling test**
L5 Principal (leadership)	All 5 C + all 5 B + 4 of 5 A	Badges, the **L5 leveling test** and a team lead or manager post

Leveling tests, each quarter

A case exam across the level's badges, plus the last 6 months: QA 95%+ for L3, 97%+ for L4 and L5, no missed deadlines.

Annual top 10%

Each December the top 10% of each level earn the missing badges of their level. A top-10% L2 moves up to L3 without the test.

SKILL BADGES

15 badges in three families

C · Core

All five for L1 · 38 h classroom

- C1 Attaching Docs
- C2 Claim Follow-up
- C3 Appeal
- C4 Payment Posting
- C5 Medical-Necessity Report

B · Specialist

Three for L2, all five for L3 · 64 h

- B1 Coding
- B2 IDR Process Workflow
- B3 MVA and WComp
- B4 Payer Strategy
- B5 Payer Outreach

A · Advanced

1 for L3, 3 for L4, 4 for L5 · 62 h

- A1 Reporting and Analysis
- A2 IDR Strategy
- A3 Medical Terminology
- A4 Billing Strategy
- A5 Innovation

Every badge: Academy module, supervised production, then an assessment in a quarterly test window. People who already do the work can test out.

PAY PRINCIPLES

Three commitments on pay

1 · Protection

No one's pay goes down

Not in the transition, not when levels are set, and not after a badge review. The level follows the badges; pay stays protected.

2 · Progression

Every move up comes with a pay raise

There is no minimum time in a level. L1 and L2 move up at the next quarterly window once the badges are held.

3 · One bonus

The bridge night rota pool is the only bonus

$30,000 a quarter, shared equally by the people who opt in and work the nights.

Annual merit reviews follow the company's existing policy.

STANDARDS

Badges are tested each quarter and reviewed twice a year

Quarterly test windows

Last two weeks of March, June, September and December, for every badge and the leveling tests. People who already do the work can test out, then 10 supervised cases.

KPI review, June 30 and December 31

A badge is lost for QA below its keep threshold for the half-year, 2 or more critical errors, or a suspension not re-earned.

Level	Badges held	Probation: 25% lost	Termination: 50% lost
L1	5	2	3
L2	8	2	4
L3	11	3	6
L4	13	4	7
L5	14	4	7

June 2027 is coaching only; badge loss counts from December 2027. Subject to HR and legal review.

TRANSITION

Transition, January–March 2027

Step	What happens
December 2026	Rank everyone within their role on 2026 KPIs. Default: Seniors L3; Negotiators, Coders, Billers L2.
Role badges	Negotiator C2, C5, B2, B5, A2. Coder C1, C5, B1, A3. Biller C1, C2, C3, C4, B5, plus B3 for MVA or workers' comp. Senior: their specialty's badges.
Top 10%	Earn their role badges with no tests and are confirmed at their default level
Middle 80%	Optional January assessment; role-badge tests in February or March. Fail: down one level. Pass the next level's set: up one.
Bottom 10%	L1 and the Academy; back to L2 automatically once they hold the L2 badges
April 1, 2027	Levels take effect. Every move up comes with a pay raise; no one's pay goes down.
December 31, 2027	Missing badges earned through cross-training; levels held provisionally until then. Team leads and managers keep their posts and complete the L5 set.

"No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards."

OUR PEOPLE

What changes for each team, and what they get

Team	What changes	What they get
Coders (10)	Code for their team; learn follow-up, OMB and posting	Specialist badges and a path to L3 and L4
Billers (35)	Take over Open Negotiation, then learn IDR	IDR work and Tier 1 portfolios
Negotiators (27)	No Gateway data entry; more time on offers	More time on what drives recovery
Team leads (12)	Run a team day to day; no longer staff the bridge	L5 Team Lead; first in line for ~7 manager seats
Managers (10)	Own one team's results; 3 also run a shared program	L5 Manager; equal teams, compared fairly

No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards.

GROWTH

What it takes to go from 12 to 31 facilities

Measure	Today	End of year 1	End of year 2
Facilities	12	21	31
Visits per day	120	~210	~310
Batched disputes per month	2,500	~4,400	~6,500
Lebanon specialists needed	~55 (have 72)	~90	~125
Teams, each with a manager	10	~12	~17
US Gateway Desk (Model C), lead included	5	~8	~11

New team

When teams run above 110% of target workload for 4 weeks

More US desk staff

When the ticket backlog stays above 1 business day for 2 weeks

Hiring

About 3 months ahead, in monthly Academy groups of 4–6

Assumes new sites average 10 visits a day, like today; we'll update with each site's forecast · 18

THE CAREER STORY

Growth opens about 21 leadership seats in two years

7
new manager seats

14
new team lead seats

Posted inside first. Today's team leads are the natural managers, and our Seniors become the next team leads.

SCORECARD

How we'll know it's working

Who	What we measure
Each specialist	Net Recovery on their portfolio, zero missed deadlines, quality score, work units, ticket accuracy
Each team	Team Net Recovery, days from service to final payment, claims over 90 and 180 days, awards paid within 30 days, attrition
US Gateway Desk	Minutes per dispute (target 15), tickets done the same day, error rate, end-of-day backlog
Coding	Coding accuracy, days from service to claim submission, NSA vs non-NSA classification errors

ClickUp tracks every NSA deadline in business days and alerts the team lead, then the manager, three days before it's due.

THE PLAN

Gateway first, then the new structure

Oct–Nov 2026

Prepare

Legal sign-off; hire 5 US staff plus 2 on contract; train in the Studio

Dec 2026

Parallel run

All Gateway work through the Studio; staff ranked on 2026 KPIs

Dec 19: full cutover

Jan–Mar 2027

Transition

10 teams formed; role-badge tests in February and March

Jan 1: Gateway US-only

Mar 15: Gate C1

Apr–Jun 2027

Cross-train

Cross-training starts; missing badges due by December 31

Apr 1: levels take effect

Jul 2027–2028

Full cycle and growth

One owner per account; 19 new facilities open into the teams

Dec 2027: first badge-loss review

Orange: Gateway transition, owned by the US desk lead and the Liaison portfolio owner. Blue: the new structure, owned by the team managers.

RISKS

What could go wrong, and what we'll do about it

Risk	How we handle it
We misread the Gateway rule	Legal sign-off before we build; Model C needs no other Gateway approval
Copy errors at the US desk	Studio validates every field; per-field checklist; night rota review; Gate C1 errors under 0.5%
The US desk falls behind	Backlog over 1 business day for 5 days, or a missed deadline: extend contracts or add staff
Deadlines slip during the change	Gateway first, structure second; deadline alerts three days out
People see new levels as a demotion	Published criteria, protected pay, one appeal; the first review is coaching only
We lose our IDR experts	Early, open communication and a Senior Specialist path that doesn't require managing
Hiring falls behind openings	Workload triggers, hiring three months ahead, monthly Academy groups

DECISIONS

What we need from you today

1. **Approve Model C,** the guided copy desk: 5 US staff, $252–307K a year today.
2. **Approve 10 full-cycle teams,** one per manager, formed after the Gateway cutover.
3. **Approve levels L0–L5 and the 15 badges,** with leveling tests for L3 to L5.
4. **Approve the testing and badge-loss policy,** subject to HR and legal review.
5. **Approve the transition plan** for January–March 2027 and its pay protection.
6. **Approve the opt-in night rota** with a $30,000 quarterly bonus pool.
7. **Approve a Senior Manager role** at L5, to chair the Academy Committee.
8. **Approve closing NNSA claims older than 12 months,** after a high-dollar review.

And confirm our commitment: no one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards.

APPENDIX

What the codes stand for

Code	Stands for
C1–C5	Core badges (C = core)
B1–B5	Specialist badges (B = specialist)
A1–A5	Advanced badges (A = advanced)
L0–L5	Junior; Specialist I, II; Senior Specialist I, II; Principal (leaders)
TL	Team Lead
OON	Out of network
NSA	No Surprises Act claims
NNSA	Non-NSA claims

Code	Stands for
IDR	Independent Dispute Resolution
IDRE	The arbitrator that decides a dispute
OMB	Open Negotiation notice form
QPA	Payer's median in-network rate
MVA	Motor vehicle accident claims
WComp	Workers' compensation claims
DOS	Date of service
QA	Quality assurance department